▼ GLASSHOUSE



A FRIEND IN NEED...

Old school friends usually reunite over chai and nostalgia, but Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** and his mate from B.N. School in Vadnagar, Gujarat, **Asgarali Vohra**, had more urgent business when they met at the PM's residence in Delhi on September 8. Vohra, 81, who now lives in Mumbai, sought Modi's intervention and a CBI probe into a land grab case involving a 2,810 sq. m. plot he bought in Bhayander in 1989. He alleged the plot was encroached upon in 2011 using forged documents by two builders, one of whom he linked to BJP MLA Narendra Mehta. An FIR was registered in 2015, but nothing came of it. But after the meeting in Delhi, Mehta gave up his claim on September 15, and Vohra got back his land. Moral of the story: never lose touch with old school friends.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ WHAT'S IN AN ACRONYM?

CHOOSE YOUR PDA

With the 2027 assembly election creeping up in Uttar Pradesh, Samajwadi Party chief **Akhilesh Yadav's** ingenious acronym, 'PDA', shorthand for 'Pichhda, Dalit, Alpsankhyak' electoral coalition, has become fair game for his rivals. BJP state poll incharge Vinod Tawde has recast it as "*Paraya Dhan Apna* (Someone else's money is ours)", while deputy CM Keshav Prasad Maurya calls it "Parivar Development Authority", to take a dig at the Yadav family. BJP ally and Suheldev Bharatiya Samaj Party chief Om Prakash Rajbhar has turned it into an election taunt, recalling his ex-ally's "*Pehle* (first)" defeat in 2017, "*Dobara* (again)" in 2022, and predicting another one "*Aage* (going forward)" in 2027. But Akhilesh is undeterred, and is even expanding the PDA. The 'A' now embraces '*Agade*' (upper castes), Adivasis and '*Aadhi aabadi*' (women), while the 'P' is wooing the Brahmins. 'P', the SP chief says, can also be for 'Pandit'.

